DO YOU KNOW?

If any wind system has all the above mentioned characters of monsoon in one season but absence of at least one in the other season then is called as 'Pseudo monsoon'. The other names are 'Monsoon tendency' or 'false monsoon'.

Monsoon system is classified into two groups based on the location. They are;

a. Asian Monsoon

b. South Asian Monsoon

a. Asian Monsoon

The Asian monsoon system is divided into two components based on season it flows. The presence of high temperature with low pressure in the lake Baikal region and low temperature with high pressure in the Aleutian islands region leading to flow of wind from Pacific Ocean to interior part of Asia during summer is called 'Summer Monsoon of Asia'. This leads to rainfall in the east coast of Asia.

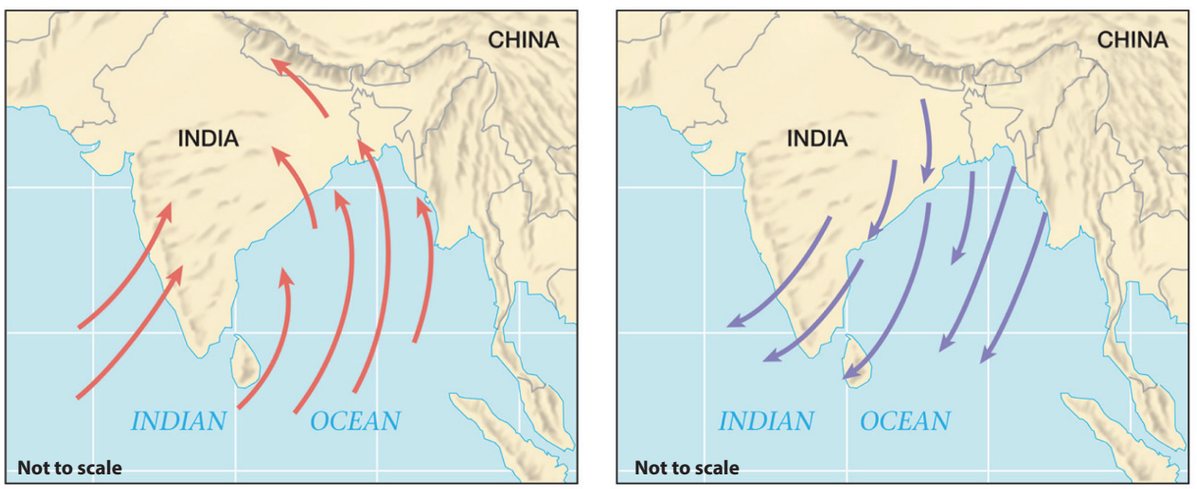
Meanwhile, in winter the low temperature and high pressure in the Lake Baikal region and high temperature and low pressure in the Aleutian Island region leading to flow of wind from Central Asia to Pacific Ocean is known as 'Winter Monsoon of Asia'. As the wind system flows off shore, the rainfall does not occur in the continent of Asia except western coast of Japan.

b. South Asian Monsoon

South Asian Monsoon includes the countries in the southern part of Himalayas, that is India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Sri lanka, Maldives, Nepal and Bhutan. This monsoon system has been classified into two groups based on the direction of origin of wind namely south west monsoon and north east monsoon (Figure 6.15).

South West Monsoon

During summer the Indian peninsula is heated more than the sea around it. Intense low pressure is formed in the region of Peshawar of Pakistan. At the same time, the Indian Ocean has higher pressure due to relatively low temperature. So the wind



Summer Winter

Figure 6.15 South Asia Monsoon

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